INSPIRING THE MAKER SPIRIT

SPJIMR'S FOCUS IS MERGING INNOVATION WITH RESPONSIBILITY, AND ADAPTING IT TO AN INNOVATION-CENTRIC ENVIRONMENT

By M.G ARUN

ARUN NAGARAJ, DEAN OF S.P. JAIN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT AND RESEARCH (SPJIMR), Mumbai, considers two aspects key to academics at the institute. One is the maxim that has underlined its 45 years of existence—to be as much a steward of society as a servant of business. "To be a good manager in business is to have a strong sense of social responsibility, which you carry into business," says Nagaraj. The big change he has seen in recent years is the way technology and innovation are defining that responsibility. "What we see is a merger of innovation with responsibility. Very few schools can give a 40 years' narrative as to why a founding principle remains relevant today, and how it has been adapted to an innovation-centric environment," says Nagaraj. "That's how SPJIMR remains true to its roots."

The other is what he calls the "immersive experience" that the institute gives its 350-odd students every year. This year, the institute has expanded the scope of industry experience for students. "The idea is to place a student in different scenarios, allow them to go out, talk to people see things and they work... giving them as much experience as possible," he explains. The experiences, he says, expose students to such diverse issues as rural challenges, low income groups and urban poverty, which in turn will help shape his/her approach to key issues.

Also part of this is understanding the way start-ups work. At the WISE Tech India Pitchathon 2026, a premier pan-India start-up discovery network that SPJIMR has designed and which provides validation and a gateway to an accelerator programme, 1,500 start-ups across 22 cities participated. Students were able to closely interact with these start-ups, especially the 500 semi-finalists, to get first-hand insight on

TOP 10 PRIVATE B-SCHOOLS

RANK (2026)	NAME OF THE INSTITUTE	CITY	STATE
1	S.P. JAIN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT & RESEARCH (SPJIMR)	Mumbai	Maharashtra
2	XLRI - XAVIER SCHOOL OF MANAGEMENT	Jamshedpur	Jharkhand
3	MANAGEMENT DEVELOPMENT INSTITUTE (MDI) GURGAON	Gurugram	Haryana
4	SVKM'S NMIMS, SCHOOL OF BUSINESS MANAGEMENT	Mumbai	Maharashtra
5	SYMBIOSIS INSTITUTE OF BUSINESS MANAGEMENT (SIBM), PUNE	Pune	Maharashtra
6	SYMBIOSIS CENTRE FOR MANAGEMENT & HUMAN RESOURCE DEVELOPMENT (SCMHRD)	Pune	Maharashtra
7	INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT TECHNOLOGY (IMT), GHAZIABAD	Ghaziabad	Uttar Pradesh
8	INTERNATIONAL MANAGEMENT INSTITUTE (IMI), NEW DELHI	New Delhi	Delhi
9	GREAT LAKES INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT	Chennai	Tamil Nadu
10	XAVIER INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT (XIMB)	Bhubaneswar	Odisha
10	T.A. PAI MANAGEMENT INSTITUTE (TAPMI), MANIPAL	Manipal	Karnataka